

engine and submitted those results to the court without confirming the validity of those case citations.

It is a fundamental duty of attorneys and non-attorneys alike to *read* the legal authorities they cite to determine that the authorities stand for the proposition for which they are cited. The court believes that both attorneys and non-attorneys alike must be on notice that AI engines have a risk of generating false or “hallucinated” results to queries of any kind -- legal citations included -- and that results obtained through AI need to be verified before submission to court. A trip to one’s county law library can help one determine whether citations are *bona fide*, and in addition whether *bona fide* citations are currently “good” law.

The court imposes a sanction of \$50 on Plaintiff, due and payable within 45 calendar days of this order to the Contra Costa Superior Court. In the alternative, Plaintiff may visit a county law library, learn how to verify legal citations with the assistance of a law librarian, and submit a minimum 500 word essay describing how to verify legal citations obtained from AI. In addition to this essay, Plaintiff must also submit a declaration from a law librarian describing under penalty of perjury [1] their name and job, and [2] what resources for verifying legal citations he or she explained to Plaintiff on what date. If Plaintiff opts to submit an essay and a law librarian’s declaration, these documents are due to be filed and served within 45 calendar days of this order. Every county in California has a law library. The law library in Contra Costa County is located at 1026 Escobar Street, Suite 2C, Martinez, CA 94553.

Failure either to pay the sanction or submit an essay and declaration in a timely fashion may result in further monetary sanctions. Forty five days from June 12, 2026 is July 27, 2026.

16. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C26-00225  
CASE NAME: MONTE DAVIS VS. VINCENT RODRIGUEZ  
\*HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: TO SET ASIDE DEFAULT RE: VINCENT RODRIQUEZ  
FILED BY: RODRIGUEZ, VINCENT  
\*TENTATIVE RULING:\*

The unopposed motion to set aside the default of Vincent Rodriguez is granted. The default taken on March 16, 2026 is set aside. Defendant Vincent Rodriguez must file a responsive pleading within 15 calendar days of June 12, 2026.